

An abstract digital illustration. In the center, a person in a dark coat stands with their back to the viewer, pointing towards a large, stylized face that appears to be composed of digital data or code. The face is rendered in shades of blue and green. To the right, a large, glowing yellow sphere, resembling a globe or a planet, is visible. The background is a mix of dark blue, green, and yellow, with vertical lines and a red, swirling pattern at the bottom. The overall style is futuristic and technological.

Agents of Change

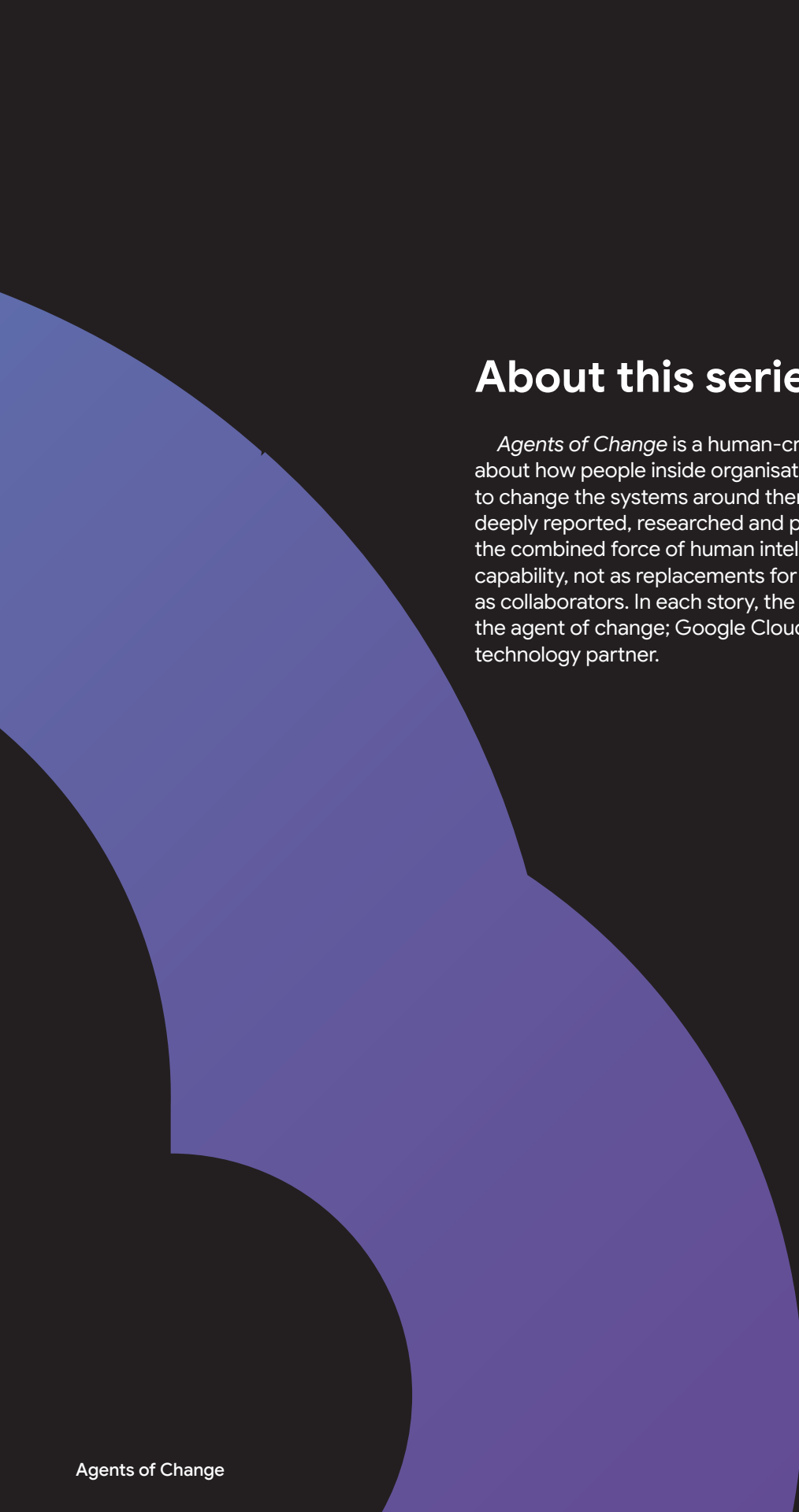




The orchestrators: breaking the enterprise paradox

How TCS working with AI from Google Cloud replaced months of 'Why can't we?' to 'here's how' enterprises can move fast on AI from the front lines to the boardroom.

Chapter 3 | Agents of Change by Google Cloud



About this series

Agents of Change is a human-crafted narrative series about how people inside organisations use technology to change the systems around them. These stories are deeply reported, researched and produced through the combined force of human intelligence and machine capability, not as replacements for one another, but as collaborators. In each story, the customer team is the agent of change; Google Cloud is the enabling technology partner.

The Breakthrough

The story begins in the “Ordinary World” of the enterprise. A place of high belief but low evidence when it comes to AI. For two years, companies have funded pilots at reckless rates, yet most results remain trapped in a cycle of “why can’t we do that?”.

Inside IT organizations, progress is often stalled by an exhausted list of obstacles: messy data, security fears, cultural resistance, and fuzzy ROI. Software has become a bottleneck, and the traditional “requirements doc” has become a graveyard for innovation.

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) decided to break this cycle by treating AI not as a tool to be “rolled out,” but as a new kind of coworker. Led by Krish Ashok, an executive who spots “everything changes” moments early, TCS began sending small, “AI-native” teams into boardrooms to do the unthinkable: build a working prototype in two hours, not two months.

The impact of this approach was immediate and profound. It didn’t just produce a working app; it obliterated the organizational inertia that had kept AI trapped in the pilot phase for years. By delivering a functional, live artifact in the same room where the problem was first defined, the team demonstrated that the ‘last mile’ of deployment wasn’t a technical impossibility, but a strategic choice.

This shift from theoretical slide-decks to ‘Rapid Build’ artifacts fundamentally changed the corporate conversation from managing risk to accelerating reality, proving that the gap between imagination and implementation has finally closed.

The paradox

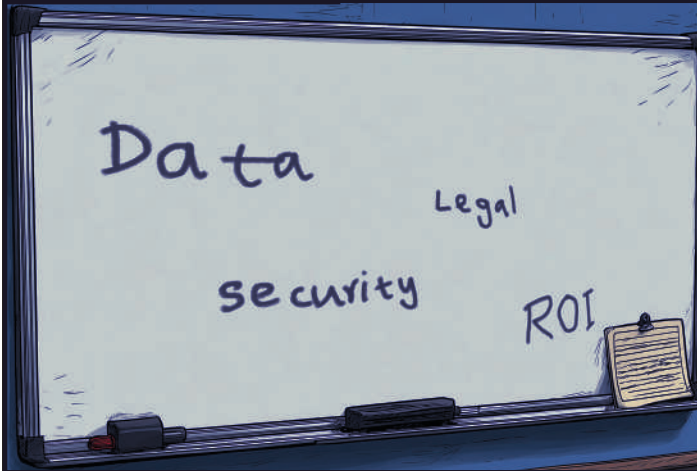
FOR TWO YEARS, THE WORLD OF ENTERPRISE AI HAS LIVED IN A PARADOX. EVERYONE BELIEVES, BUT ALMOST NO ONE HAS PROOF.



COMPANIES FUND PILOTS AT RECKLESS RATES, YET THE QUESTION REMAINS: "WHY CAN'T WE ACTUALLY DO THIS?"



AI ISN'T A NEW APP. IT'S ELECTRICITY. FOUNDATIONAL. IT'S GOING TO RESHAPE WHAT COUNTS AS WORK.



Data Legal
security ROI

THE ANSWER IS ALWAYS A LONG, EXHAUSTED SENTENCE. THE PROCESS IS BROKEN. THE DATA IS MESSY. THE CULTURE RESISTS.



The heroes emerge

AT TCS, THEY STOPPED WAITING FOR THE WORLD TO CHANGE.
THEY HIRED THE AGENTS OF CHANGE INSTEAD.

I WILL DO
AI. PLEASE
HIRE ME.



SAM. A "BREAKER." HE DOESN'T WANT TO
FOLLOW A ROADMAP; HE WANTS TO SEE
HOW THE ENGINE WORKS.

FELINA. A "DECIDER." SHE BYPASSED THE
SYSTEM BECAUSE THE SYSTEM WAS TOO
SLOW TO FIND HER.

THEY AREN'T JUST
EMPLOYEES. THEY
ARE A NEW KIND
OF COWORKER.

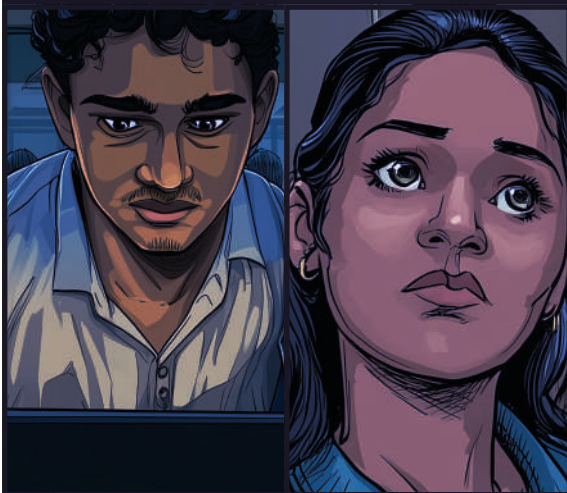


Crossing the threshold

*TWELVE CHAIRS. SIX FROM GOOGLE, SIX FROM TCS.
AND A DEMO THAT HAS TO WORK NOW.*



*NO SLIDES. NO ROADMAPS. JUST LIVE CODE IN
FRONT OF THE PEOPLE WHO RUN THE WORLD.*



*IN THIS ROOM, YOU CAN FEEL THE
FEAR BEFORE YOU SEE IT.*



The glitch

EVERY HERO FACES A MOMENT WHERE THE MAGIC FAILS.

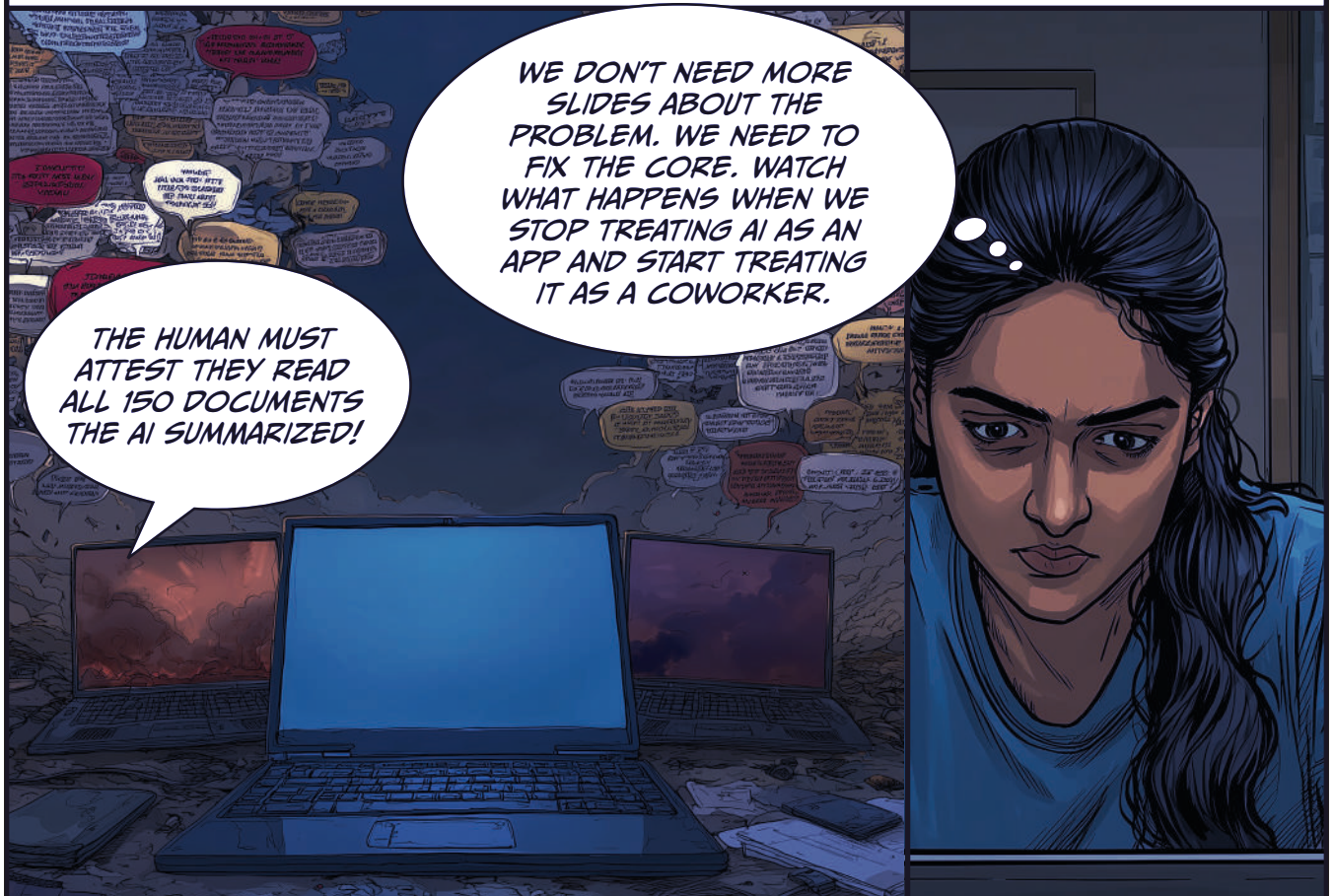


The legacy debt

FOR DECADES, BUSINESS ADDRESS VERIFICATION WAS A MANUAL MAZE OF MESSY DATA AND DUPLICATE LISTINGS. THE "THIS DOESN'T SCALE" REALITY MEANT HUMAN CALLS, FRICTION, AND WASTED MONTHS.

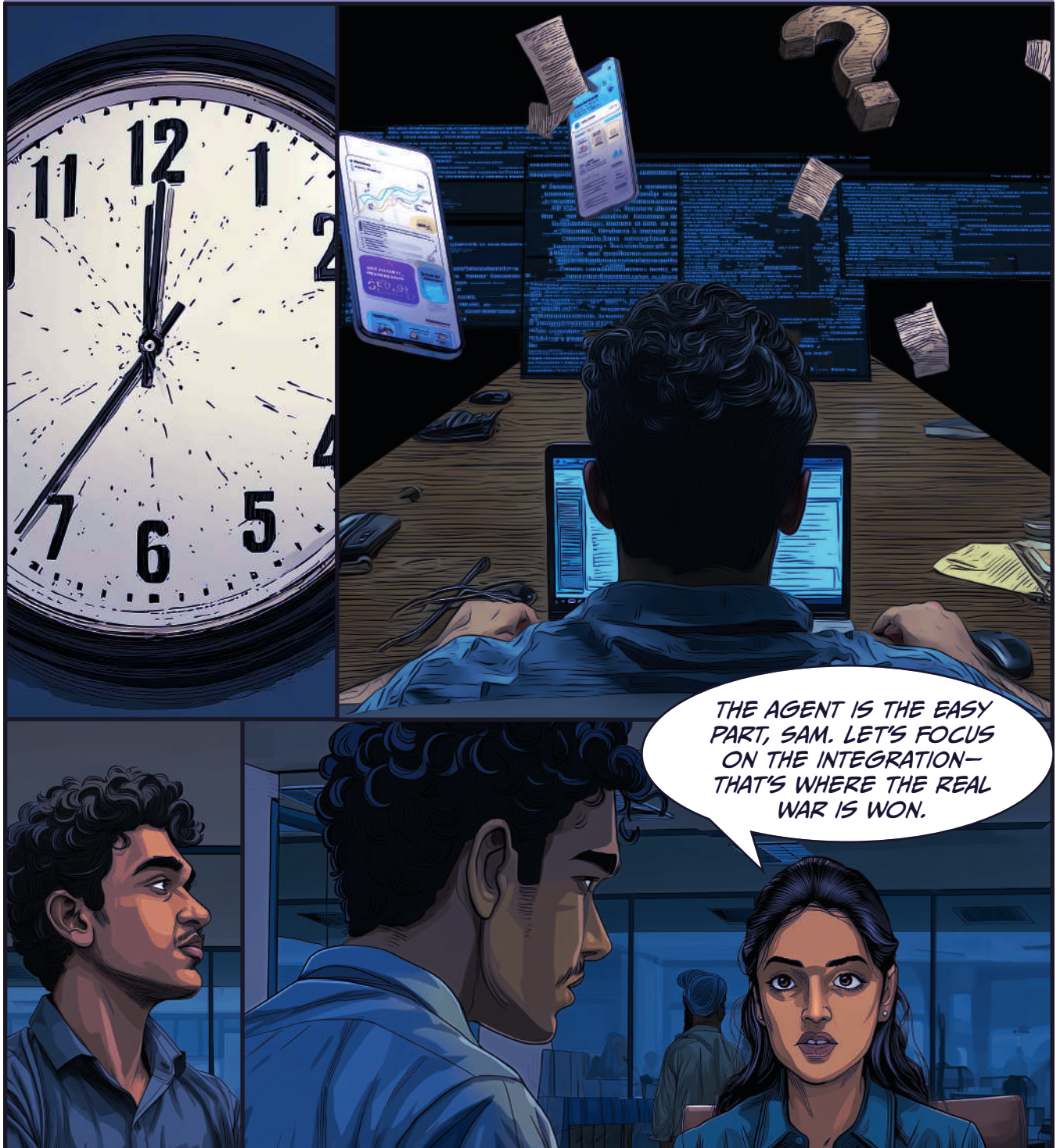


BALA IS THE BRIDGE. HE HANDLES THE "MAZE" OF THE ORGANIZATION SO SAM AND FELINA CAN STAY IN THE FLOW.



Manufacturing proof in 4 days

IN JUST 96 HOURS, FELINA MOVES FROM MESSY DATA TO A WORKING ARTIFACT. THIS ISN'T A PILOT; IT'S A "RAPID BUILD" DESIGNED TO SHOW LEADERS THE CHANGE.



THE AGENT IS THE EASY PART, SAM. LET'S FOCUS ON THE INTEGRATION—THAT'S WHERE THE REAL WAR IS WON.

THE SKILL HAS SHIFTED FROM WRITING CODE TO ORCHESTRATION. FELINA DOESN'T WAIT FOR A ROADMAP; SHE BUILDS THE ENGINE.

The breakthrough



The moment of truth

THE AGENT—THE "VOICE OF TRUTH"—MAKES A REAL-TIME CALL TO VERIFY A BUSINESS ADDRESS IN TAMIL. LIVE, NOT A CONCEPT DEMONSTRATION.



வணக்கம்
(HELLO), I AM
CALLING TO VERIFY
YOUR BUSINESS
ADDRESS...



உங்கள்
முகவரியைச்
சரிபார்க்க நான்
அழைக்கிறேன்...

THE AUDIENCE DOESN'T JUST SEE A DEMO; THEY SEE A FUTURE THEY CAN ASSEMBLE WITH THEIR OWN HANDS. IF THE AGENT HITS A SNAG, IT DOESN'T JUST FAIL. IT CAPTURES EVIDENCE AND ESCALATES TO A HUMAN. THE LOOP IS CLOSED; THE LISTING IS UPDATED.

The immersion

THE HERO DOESN'T JUST WIN; THEY TEACH OTHERS HOW TO FIGHT.



Lipstick on a pig

THE GREATEST ENEMY ISN'T TECHNOLOGY. IT'S THE LEGACY.



The new unit of work

THE HEROES REALIZE THEY AREN'T JUST "CODERS" ANYMORE.



The shift in power

THE "ADULTS" IN THE ROOM REALIZE THE WORLD HAS CHANGED.



The new mythology

THEY AREN'T WAITING FOR PERMISSION. THEY ARE MANUFACTURING PROOF.



IT'S A JOKE, BUT IT'S ALSO NOT. THEY HAVEN'T BEEN TRAINED TO "SHRINK" YET.



THE FUTURE ISN'T COMING. IT'S BEING BUILT. RIGHT NOW. IN TWO HOURS.

In that board boardroom, as the demo flickered to life, the “proof” did more than just work. It shifted the atmosphere. It convinced a room full of experienced leaders that they had been underestimating how fast their world could change.

The story of Sam and Felina isn’t just about technical skill; it’s about a new mindset where “impossible” is simply a negotiable constraint. They represent a shift from traditional “software engineering” to “orchestration.”

While the “system” continues to push back with governance and legacy debt, organisations such as TCS are already moving. They aren’t waiting for task assignments or 150-page manuals. Like Sam and Felina, they are manufacturing proof, behaving as if the future is something you can assemble with your own hands, two hours at a time.

The future of the enterprise will not be defined by those who simply adopt AI tools, but by those who reorganize their entire operation around the concept of ‘Orchestration’. We are moving into an era where the primary unit of work is no longer the individual task, but the continuous manufacturing of proof. In this future, the traditional barriers of legacy debt and bureaucratic friction will be dismantled by agents of change. As this mindset scales, the speed of business will finally match the speed of thought, turning every boardroom from a theater of ‘what if’ into a studio of ‘what’s next’.

Coming up next

Morning glory

